2002
Crossing The Billion PC Mark

April 17: PCIe

The PCI-Express standard was launched. A new era of graphics technology was brought to the forefront because of this. PCI (Peripheral Connect Interface) was slow, offering a data bandwidth of just 133 MBps. Considering that the average Pentium 4 CPU was capable of 2.1 GBps, PCI was functioning at a snail's pace. AGP (Accelerated Graphics Port) was brought in to try and reduce this, and the latest version of AGP 8X was capable of an impressive 2.1 GBps bandwidth. However, with graphics, no amount of speed is ever enough, and with other components getting faster, a new interface was needed that not only connected graphics cards but controllers for other high speed devices as well. PCI-Express (PCIe) was the answer, and offered a slightly higher 2.5 GBps bandwidth. PCIe x16 slots increased this to 4 GBps (almost double that of AGP 8x), and graphics manufacturers found a better way to utilise this available bandwidth to use two PCIe x16 ports to split the 16 available bandwidth lanes and add on two graphics cards. ATI's Crossfire and NVIDIA's SLI enabled the enthusiast gamer to run two graphics cards in tandem and experience a much higher level of graphics quality.

June 30: A billion PCs

Research firm Gartner announced that over 1 billion PCs had been shipped to users since the beginning of the technology era. This does not mean there are 1 billion PC users in the world, however, because it counts the number of PCs shipped, and since the 1970s, end users may have gone through anything from three to 10 PCs each. The news was big though, and marked the dominance of technology in the global market share.

August 24: Jaguar follows Puma

Apple released Jaguar (Mac OS X 10.2). It is from this point on that Apple started referring to and marketing their OS upgrades using the codenames instead of the version numbers. Jaguar brought